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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Record property tax hikes slam Chicago homeowners

South and West sides hit especially hard, while downtown offices see cuts

By A.D. Quig and Alex Nitkin
Chicago Tribune

This story is a collaboration between the Illinois Answers Project and the Chicago Tribune.

Chicago homeowners are being walloped with a record property tax hike, with some of the city's poorest neighborhoods absorb-

ing the steepest increases even as downtown office owners see their bills fall, according to new data from the Cook County treasurer's office.

An analysis from Cook County Treasurer Maria Pappas' office found the median property tax bill for a Chicago homeowner jumped 16.7% since last year, the largest percentage increase in at

least 30 years. The surge follows similar spikes in Cook County's north and south suburbs over the last two years and complicates the job of the Chicago City Council as it considers tax hikes to help close a historic budget gap.

The long-awaited second installment of Cook County property tax

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Audrey Pierce, 71, stands by her three-flat in North Lawndale on Sunday. She saw her property tax bill for the building more than double this year. "To put it mildly, I'm very pissed off," she said. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**



Bronze turkey hens roam in a fenced, grassy area after being fed Friday at All Grass Farms in Dundee Township. Poultry farmer Cliff McConville said his flock has not been affected by bird flu. **DOMINIC DI PALERMO/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Bird flu cases rising again, including 2 million turkeys

Disease among factors leading to rise in some prices ahead of Thanksgiving

By Adriana Pérez and Claire Malon
Chicago Tribune

Out on his farm in Dundee Township, Cliff McConville sees geese landing in the fields where his turkeys and chickens graze. It's a sight that often unnerves poultry producers, as migratory waterfowl carry and spread a highly infectious strain of bird flu that

has been resurging in the United States for the last three years.

So far this year, McConville's farm and most turkey farms in Illinois — of which there are more than 400 — have not been affected by the disease. Eight farms in the state have reported cases to the federal government, and only two of those were turkey flocks.

"We raise them outdoors," McConville said of the poultry

operations at All Grass Farms in the northwest suburbs. "They're going to mix with (wild) birds. So we just have to do our best to keep them healthy. ... That's worked for us so far. Knock on wood."

But larger turkey-producing states have been hit hard in the past couple of months. Nearly 2 million turkeys have been affected by bird flu across the country since August, accounting for roughly 24% of all new cases in commercial and backyard flocks, even though turkeys only account for approximately 2% of the U.S. poultry inventory.

According to experts, the disease — combined with a drop of almost 10% in turkey meat production from last year, rising labor costs and lower overall consumer demand throughout the year — is triggering higher prices for wholesale and fresh turkeys just ahead of the holiday season. Frozen turkeys are not likely to be as affected.

More than a third of those recent cases came from Minnesota, where, as of Friday, more than 716,000 commercial turkeys

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Nations feel heat at climate summit

Some negotiators to push for more big-picture action

By Seth Borenstein, Anton L. Delgado and Melina Walling
Associated Press

BELEM, Brazil — Going into United Nations climate negotiations a week ago, the Brazilian hosts weren't looking for big end-of-session pronouncements on lofty goals. The two-week COP30 conference was supposed to hyperfocus on "implementation" of past promises not yet kept.

That's out the window. Now, halfway through the talks, the urgency of climate change is causing some negotiators to push for more big-picture action — on weak plans to cut emissions of heat-trapping gases, on too little money to help nations wracked by climate change, on putting teeth into phasing out coal, oil and gas.

Because of that pressure to do more — including from Brazil President Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva — the diplomat chairing the talks said Saturday that he'll consider a big-picture, end-of-negotiations communiqué, sometimes known as a decision or cover text.

"I think things have changed, which is a very good thing," said veteran observer Jean Su of the Center for Biological Diversity. "So I think there's momentum that we will get some type of decision text, and our hope is that in particular there's going to be some commitment on phasing out fossil fuels."

"I would say that what's at stake now is probably higher than the last several COPs because you're looking at an

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INSIDE

Suspect charged 21 years after Gold Coast man's killing

Two dozen relatives and friends of Kent Projansky packed a Cook County courtroom over the weekend as a former neighbor of Projansky appeared on first-degree murder charges. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

Former director of Old Town School of Folk Music dies

James "Bau" Graves led the venerable institution for more than 11 years, steering it through a major expansion in Chicago's Lincoln Square neighborhood. **Page 11**

BEARS 19, VIKINGS 17



CHRIS SWEDA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Down to the wire again

Bears kicker Cairo Santos celebrates after kicking a game-winning 48-yard field goal in the last seconds of the fourth quarter against the Vikings in Minneapolis on Sunday. **Chicago Sports**

Pritzker's accountability panel still ramping up

As federal immigration surge starts to subside, commission to probe raids lacks reporting system

By Dan Petrella
Chicago Tribune

Gov. JB Pritzker's chief of staff took to social media last week to call out federal agents for taking a break from their militarized immigration enforcement operation in the Chicago area to play tourist and pose for group photos in front of the iconic Cloud Gate sculpture in Millennium Park.

"These jerks went to the Bean this morning where they took a picture where instead of saying 'cheese' they said 'Little Village' — the name of the community they terrorized over the weekend,"

Pritzker chief of staff Anne Caprara wrote, sharing a link to a Block Club Chicago story documenting the photo op.

"The only good thing is we will be handing over this picture to the Illinois Accountability Commission," Caprara wrote, referring to the body Pritzker formed late last month in order to "create an official public record" of the "impropriety, brutality and harassment perpetrated" by federal agents participating in the months-long crackdown known as "Operation Midway Blitz."

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